position of the anti-Zionist system is that Jews belong to a religious community but do not form a nation. Thus, they are not entitled to a sovereign state. Writing in 1969, the Israeli intelligence analyst and scholar, Yehoshafat Harkabi, explained that according to the religious and ideological worldview of the Arabs, the Jews have no claim to national self-determination:

> The conception that the Jews do not constitute a national entity is a vital principle for the Arab position. For if the Israelis do constitute a nation, then they have the right of self-determination, and the claim that only the Palestinian Arabs have the right of self-determination, and that only they must decide the national character of the country, is invalid. Moreover, the Arab claim for exclusive national self-determination appears in all its starkness as chauvinism that demands rights for itself which are denied to the other.[21]

Writing in 1975, historian Bernard Lewis described this objection and explained its practical implication:

> The PLO in its literature never uses the expression "Arabs and Jews," for to do so would be to admit the existence of a Jewish nation and it is cardinal to the PLO ideology that there is no such thing. The formula which they use is "Muslims, Christians and Jews." The Jews, in their view, are purely a religious minority who possess no separate national identity and have no right to a separate state. . . .[22]

Yehoshafat Harkabi further described and analysed the Arabs' existential objection to the Jewish State and Zionism:

> Recognition of the existence of Israel as a truly legitimate entity entails a certain acknowledgment that the state was not born in sin, in other words, recognition that there is justice to Zionism. Furthermore, the rejection of Zionism, presented by Arab leaders as "Jewish nationalism," is based on depriving the Jews of their national status. The Jews are described as a religious community and not a nation or peoplehood and therefore do not merit a state.[23]

From the negation of peoplehood, the enemies of the Zionist enterprise simply derive the proposition that the Jewish state lacks legitimacy and does not have a legitimate reason for being. Pierre-André Taguieff observed that

> To glorify the actions of the terrorist as those of a hero or martyr, it is necessary to adopt the formula dear to revolutionaries that "the end justifies the means." The end that here gives absolute justification is the sacred cause, open to various interpretations within the perspective of Palestinian national Islamism but often

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